Returns Program: Weekly Business Review

Week of 2026-10-26 to 2026-11-01 | generated 2026-11-05 | scope: US, UK, DE, CA; all categories and return channels

Headline

- 3 of 8 KPIs met target for the week of 2026-10-26 to 2026-11-01; 3 are Amber and 2 are Red (Refund cycle time, Customer contacts per return).
- Refund cycle time was 3.77 days vs a 3.30 days target (+14.2% unfavourable), +0.06 days WoW and +0.28 days YoY; it has missed target 4 of the last 4 weeks.
- Customer contacts per return was 0.192 vs a 0.180 target (+6.8% unfavourable), +0.003 WoW and +0.009 YoY; it has missed target 4 of the last 4 weeks.
- Driver: US Mail-in accounts for +0.44 days, more than the whole +0.43-day program change vs the pre-incident baseline (all other segments net -0.01 days). Its cycle time rose from 4.08 to 6.27 days, and +2.22 days of that is carrier transit, not warehouse processing (-0.03 days).
- Bright spot: Waste (landfill) units at 10,829 (-29.2% YoY), ahead of its 11,000 target.
- Program health: 2 initiatives Red (Drop-off point expansion, Return reason capture redesign), 2 Amber, 1 Green. 6 milestones are at risk, 3 are blocked by a dependency, and 5 High risks are open.
- Critical path: M402 QR label and reason-code API (Returns Experience Tech, forecast 2026-11-13) is blocking 3 downstream milestones, including drop-off Wave 2, which is the structural fix for mail-in transit delays.

KPI scorecard

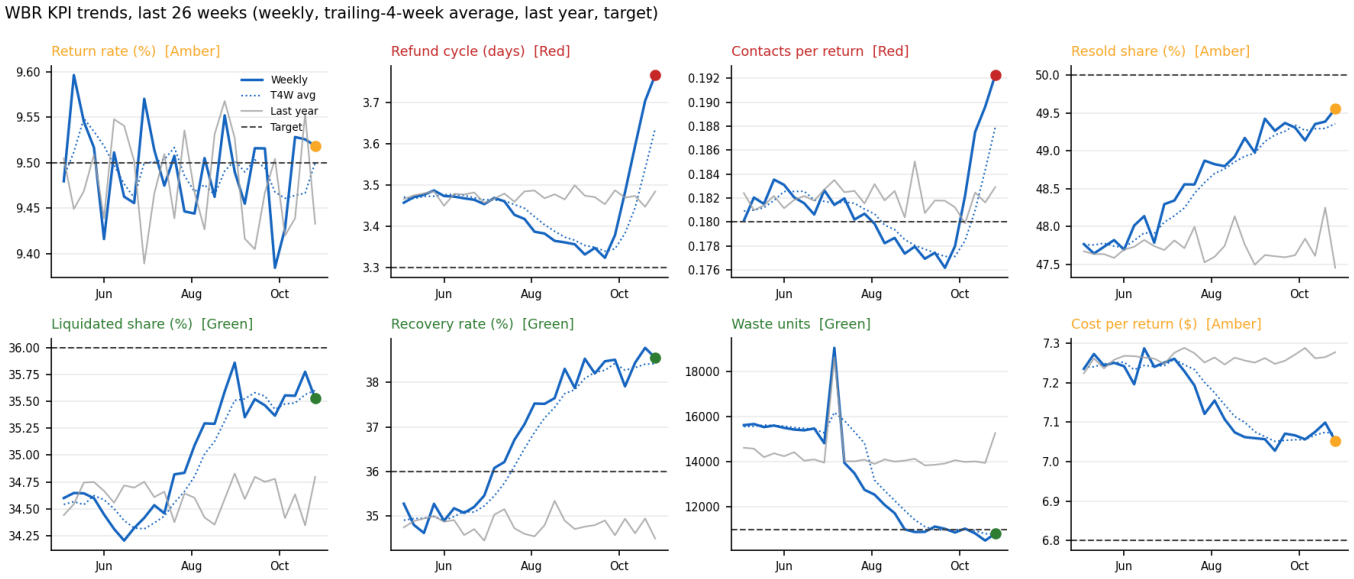
KPI	Current	Prior wk	WoW	Last year	YoY %	T4W avg	Target	Var % (unfav +)	RAG	Missed last 4
Return rate	9.5%	9.5%	-0.0 pts	9.4%	+0.9%	9.5%	9.5%	+0.2%	Amber	3
Refund cycle time	3.77 days	3.70 days	+0.06 days	3.48 days	+8.1%	3.64 days	3.30 days	+14.2%	Red	4
Customer contacts per return	0.192	0.190	+0.003	0.183	+5.1%	0.188	0.180	+6.8%	Red	4
Resold share of dispositions	49.6%	49.4%	+0.2 pts	47.5%	+4.4%	49.4%	50.0%	+0.9%	Amber	4
Liquidated share of dispositions	35.5%	35.8%	-0.2 pts	34.8%	+2.1%	35.6%	36.0%	-1.3%	Green	0
Recovery rate ($ recovered / $ refunded)	38.6%	38.8%	-0.2 pts	34.5%	+11.8%	38.4%	36.0%	-7.1%	Green	0
Waste (landfill) units	10,829	10,515	+314	15,285	-29.2%	10,806	11,000	-1.6%	Green	1
Cost per return	$7.05	$7.10	-$0.05	$7.28	-3.1%	$7.07	$6.80	+3.7%	Amber	4

Status: 3 Green, 3 Amber, 2 Red. RAG rule: Green = at or better than target; Amber = worse than target but within the KPI's tolerance band (3-5%); Red = outside the band. WoW = vs prior week; YoY = vs the same week 52 weeks earlier; T4W = mean of the last 4 weekly values. Percent KPIs show WoW in percentage points.

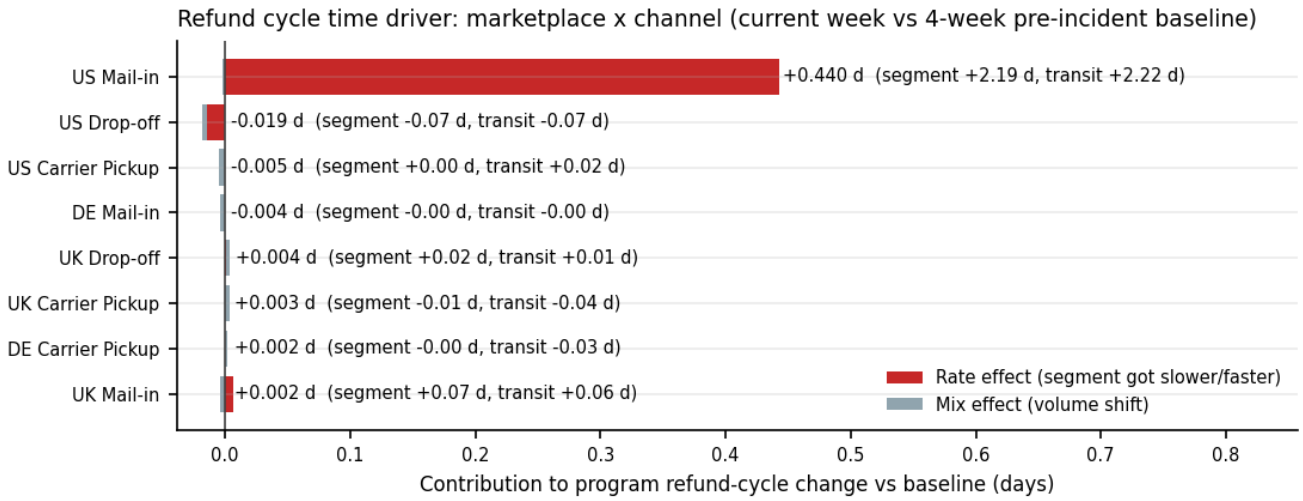
Program health at a glance

Initiative	Team	Done	At risk	Blocked	Max slip (d)	Open High risks	RAG
Drop-off point expansion	Reverse Logistics Ops	3/6	2	1	56	2	Red
Return reason capture redesign	Returns Experience Tech	1/5	3	2	63	1	Red
Grade-and-resell open-box electronics	ReCommerce	3/6	1	0	21	1	Amber
Returnless refunds for low-value items	Returns Policy	4/6	0	0	14	1	Amber
Liquidation partner onboarding	Liquidation & Disposition	3/5	0	0	14	0	Green

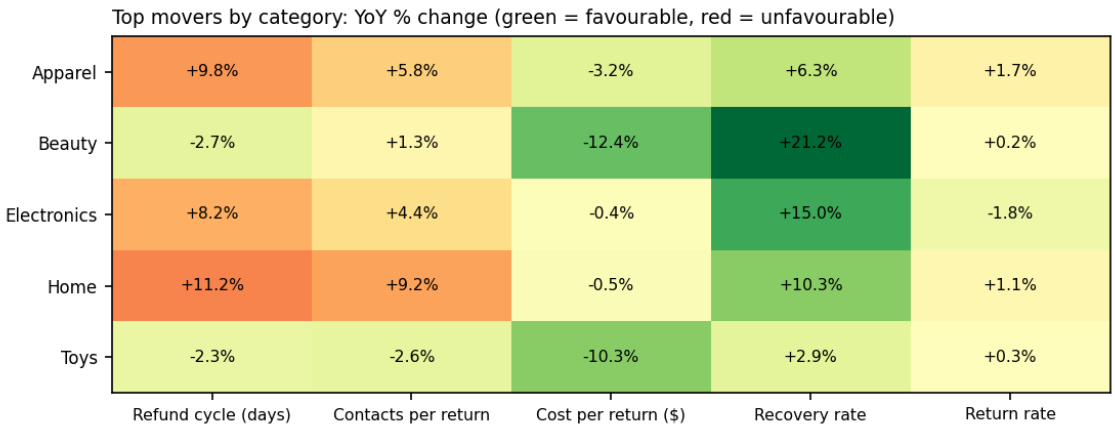
KPI trends (26 weeks)



Why refund cycle time is Red: driver decomposition



Top movers by category (YoY)



Milestones at risk

ID	Milestone	Owner role	Planned end	Forecast	Status	Slip (d)	RAG
M104	Scale grading to 6 sites	Returns Operations Manager	2026-10-30	2026-11-20	At Risk	21	Amber
M304	Wave 2 go-live (900 points, US/CA)	Reverse Logistics Program Manager	2026-10-02	2026-11-27	Blocked	56	Red
M305	Carrier consolidation SLA review	Transportation Manager	2026-11-06	2026-11-20	At Risk	14	Amber
M402	QR label and reason-code API	Software Development Manager	2026-09-11	2026-11-13	At Risk	63	Red
M403	Return-flow UX redesign A/B test	Returns Experience Product Manager	2026-10-23	2026-12-04	Blocked	42	Red
M404	Reason-code data feed to Operations	Data Engineer	2026-12-04	2026-12-18	Not Started	14	Red

Open High risks

ID	Risk	Sev.	Owner role	Mitigation	Close by
R04	QR label API slip blocks Wave 2 drop-off go-live	20	Software Development Manager	(none recorded)	2026-10-30
R05	Carrier linehaul consolidation lengthens US mail-in transit	20	Transportation Manager	(none recorded)	2026-11-06
R07	Engineering capacity shared with peak code freeze	16	Software Development Manager	Request 2 additional SDEs; descope phase-2 fields	2026-11-06
R01	Grading labor not staffed at 4 of 6 scale sites before peak	16	Returns Operations Manager	Cross-train inbound associates; stagger site launches	2026-11-13
R03	Returnless refunds increase abuse / bad debt in new categories	15	Risk & Abuse Prevention Manager	Per-customer frequency caps; abuse dashboard (M205)	2026-11-13

Rows in red need escalation (no mitigation recorded or past target close date).

Asks and escalations (P1, due before next WBR)

- [P1] Returns Experience Tech (Software Development Manager), M402 QR label and reason-code API: Commit a firm delivery date or an interim workaround for the blocked teams. Blocks 3 milestone(s): M304 (Reverse Logistics Ops), M403 (Returns Experience Tech), M404 (Returns Experience Tech); predecessor forecast 2026-11-13. Due 2026-11-08.
- [P1] Reverse Logistics Ops (Software Development Manager), R04 QR label API slip blocks Wave 2 drop-off go-live: Assign a mitigation owner and plan, or accept the risk explicitly at the WBR. Severity 20; mitigation: none recorded; target close 2026-10-30. Due 2026-11-08.
- [P1] Reverse Logistics Ops (Transportation Manager), R05 Carrier linehaul consolidation lengthens US mail-in transit: Assign a mitigation owner and plan, or accept the risk explicitly at the WBR. Severity 20; mitigation: none recorded; target close 2026-11-06. Due 2026-11-08.
- [P1] Returns Experience Tech (Returns Experience Product Manager), Customer contacts per return: Root cause and recovery plan with a date-to-green at next WBR. 0.192 vs target 0.180 (Red). Due 2026-11-08.
- [P1] Reverse Logistics Ops (Reverse Logistics Program Manager), Refund cycle time: Root cause and recovery plan with a date-to-green at next WBR. 3.77 days vs target 3.30 days (Red). Due 2026-11-08.
- [P1] Returns Experience Tech (Software Development Manager), M402 QR label and reason-code API: Re-baseline the plan or add capacity; confirm impact on downstream milestones. Planned end 2026-09-11, forecast 2026-11-13 (63 days late). Due 2026-11-08.

Watch items (P2): Resold share of dispositions (ReCommerce); Return rate (Returns Policy); Cost per return (Reverse Logistics Ops); M104 Scale grading to 6 sites (ReCommerce); M305 Carrier consolidation SLA review (Reverse Logistics Ops).

Refresh: the pipeline runs Monday 06:00 local after the Sunday data load (Task Scheduler or cron, see src/schedule/), so this pre-read is out well before the Tuesday review.